

SCENARIO SIMULATOR — PROOF OF CONCEPT

Reading the Warning Signs

An evolving role-play in a public-sector agency. A veteran team member's behavior begins to escalate; the learner — a shift supervisor — has to recognize the level, respond correctly, and decide when to raise the alarm. How the early signs are handled changes how far it goes.

VERSION A: ANNOTATED

VERSION B: FULL DIALOGUE

Workplace Violence (PS-801) · Public Sector · Grounded in “Recognize the Levels of Violence & Response” (slides 26–28) · POC Working Session

Written discipline-agnostic to read across Fire · Law Enforcement · Dispatch · EMS

COURSE

Workplace Violence (PS-801) — Public Sector

TOPIC

Recognizing & responding to escalating workplace violence

LEARNER ROLE

A shift supervisor — Ray's direct supervisor (also lands with frontline leads)

FORMAT

One evolving scenario · four connected phases · branches on the learner's handling

GROUNDING IN

“Recognize the Levels of Violence & Response” (slides 26–28)

READS ACROSS

Fire · Law Enforcement · Dispatch · EMS — neutral agency language

THE EVOLVING ARC — one continuous situation climbing the escalation ladder

1

Notice & Assess · Level 1

See the early warning signs for what they are, document, and loop in your own chain — don't sit on it, don't go it alone.

2

The Conversation · Level 1

Meet with Ray privately: hear the grievance, set clear limits, name corrective steps, point to support — with respect, not punishment.

3

It Escalates · Level 2

A credible threat surfaces. Recognize the level has changed, secure safety, notify the chain, involve 911 if warranted — stop coaching.

4

Emergency · Level 3

A weapon / direct threat. A decision point, not a confrontation: 911, personal safety first, account for others, cooperate with law enforcement.

The path is contingent: handle Level 1 well and it can de-escalate; miss it and the situation climbs the ladder, with fewer options at each rung.

1

It reads as a management problem first

Ray is short with the crew and bitter about being passed over. Nothing screams “violence” yet — which is the point. You have to see the early signs for what they are and not explain them away.

2

You have to handle it, on the record

You sit down with Ray. He's guarded and aggrieved. You have to hear him out, set firm limits, and document it — while keeping your own chain informed instead of quietly absorbing it.

3

The ground shifts under you

A threat surfaces. The situation is no longer a coaching conversation, and you have to recognize that in the moment — secure people, notify up, bring in 911 if it's warranted.

4

Then it's an emergency

A weapon is reported. Now it's decisions, fast: call it in, protect yourself and others, and let law enforcement run it. Your job is to respond correctly, not to be the hero.

Built on the Course's Own Escalation Ladder

GROUNDING IN THE COURSE

LEVEL 1 Early Warning Signs

- BEHAVIORS**
Intimidates or bullies · disrespectful · uncooperative · verbally abusive
- HOW TO RESPOND**
Observe · document · report up the chain · meet privately and set limits
- MAPS TO**
Phases 1–2

LEVEL 2 Escalation

- BEHAVIORS**
Argues / defies policy · “me against them” · sabotage or theft · voices wish to harm · threatening notes
- HOW TO RESPOND**
Secure safety · notify the chain · 911 if warranted · stay calm · don't handle it alone
- MAPS TO**
Phase 3

LEVEL 3 Emergency

- BEHAVIORS**
Physical fight · extreme rage · a weapon · direct or suicidal threats
- HOW TO RESPOND**
Call 911 · personal safety first · leave if at risk · account for others · cooperate with law enforcement
- MAPS TO**
Phase 4

The simulator turns these three static “which level is this?” knowledge checks into one lived, evolving situation where the learner must recognize the level AND perform the response.

RAY — the team member (Phases 2–3)

DRIVER

A grievance — passed over for a lead assignment that went to Marcus, a newer colleague; feels the system is against him. (The course's “grievance” and “me against them” markers.)

BASELINE

Guarded, resentful, minimizing — “I’m fine, everyone’s overreacting.”

HANDLED WITH RESPECT + FIRM LIMITS

Feels heard, accepts the boundary, de-escalates.

HANDLED DISMISSIVELY / PUNITIVELY / IN PUBLIC

Hardens, and the grievance curdles into a threat.

The AI models an aggrieved employee — never a caricature; and the climb to Levels 2–3 comes through reports and cues, not an immersive violent confrontation.

THE BRANCH — the learner drives it

Unlike a scripted scene, how the learner handles Level 1 changes the road ahead:

RECOGNIZES + ACTS EARLY

Documents, loops in the chain, sets limits with respect.

→ DE-ESCALATES.

Ray feels heard; the situation stabilizes at Level 1.

MINIMIZES OR MISHANDLES

Ignores it, handles it publicly, or goes it alone.

→ CLIMBS THE LADDER.

To Level 2, then a Level 3 decision point — with fewer good options at each rung.

LOOK-FORS · traceable to course content

- Recognizes early warning signs as Level 1 “behaviors of concern” — not just a bad attitude. (Slide 26)
- Reports up and documents rather than sitting on it — avoids an information silo. (Slides 8, 26)
- Runs the Level 1 conversation right: private, hears the grievance, sets limits, names corrective steps, points to support. (Slide 26)
- Recognizes the shift to Level 2 and switches from coaching to securing safety + notifying the chain + 911 if warranted. (Slide 27)
- At Level 3, responds as an emergency: 911, personal safety first, account for others, cooperate with law enforcement. (Slide 28)
- Documents throughout for the violent-incident log and follows the agency's WVPP. (Slides 22, 24)

PROBLEMATIC RESPONSES TO FLAG + REDIRECT

Explains it away

“He's just venting.” → These are Level 1 behaviors of concern; observe, document, report.

Sits on it

Handles it quietly to avoid trouble for Ray. → Withholding is an information silo; loop in the chain.

Goes it alone / plays hero

Tries to manage a Level 2–3 threat solo. → Secure safety, notify, involve 911 / law enforcement.

Stays in coaching mode

Keeps counseling after a credible threat. → The level has changed; the response has to change with it.

Punitive or public at Level 1

Dresses Ray down in front of the crew. → Private, respectful, limit-setting — or it hardens the grievance.

Skips documentation

No record of behavior or steps taken. → Required for the incident log and any follow-through.

WHAT STRONG HANDLING SOUNDS LIKE — PHASE BY PHASE

Phase 1 — Notice & Assess:

“Three converging signs in two weeks is a pattern, not a mood. I'll write down what I've seen, give my supervisor a heads-up so we assess it together, and set up a private time to talk with Ray.”

Phase 2 — The Conversation:

“I get that getting passed over stung, and I want to hear that. But I've seen how it's landing on the crew, and that has to change. Here's what I need to see — and you know we've got EAP if you want it.”

Phase 3 — It Escalates:

“I'm treating this as a threat. I'll make sure Marcus is safe and looped in, notify my chain and security, preserve the message, and follow our violence-prevention plan — I'm not confronting Ray on my own.”

Phase 4 — Emergency:

“Call 911, get myself and the crew to safety, account for everyone, and give dispatch a description and exact location. Let law enforcement run it.”

AI TONE + VOICE

In-character (Ray):

Aggrieved and guarded, consequential — trust is earned; never a caricature.

The Coach:

Warm, non-judgmental, affirms before redirecting; frames gaps as growth.

Throughout:

Calm and professional — treats a serious topic without sensationalizing it.

Always:

Ends each turn with a clear next step or a forward pivot — no dead ends.

PUBLIC-SECTOR FRAMING — one scene, four disciplines

- Neutral language — agency, shift, unit, chain of command — so Fire, Law, Dispatch, and EMS all see themselves in it.
- A natural configuration point: drop in the agency's real WVPP reporting channel, EAP, and emergency protocol.

COMPLIANCE ANCHOR

California SB 553 requires a Workplace Violence Prevention Plan, incident logging, and training — the close hands every learner the SME-validated response regardless of path.

WHAT THIS POC PROVES

A genuinely branching scenario

The learner's Level 1 handling — not a script — decides whether it de-escalates or climbs the ladder.

Recognize-and-perform, not classify

Moves past “which level is this?” to doing the right thing at each level, in the moment.

A chain-of-command response

Report up, document, involve 911 / law enforcement — an organizational protocol, not a lone bystander.

High-stakes handled safely

Level 3 is a decision point, not a confrontation — proving we can do violence content responsibly.

AI PRESENTS THE SCENARIO (first-person — learner is Ray's supervisor)

SCENE STRUCTURE

Video or 2–3 readable paragraphs establish the world before any coaching: (1) you supervise a shift at a publicsector agency; (2) Ray is a 12-year veteran, recently passed over for a lead assignment that went to Marcus, a newer colleague; (3) over the last two weeks you've clocked three things — he snapped at a newer colleague, muttered that “management has it out for me,” and refused to hand a task to the new lead; (4) individually small, together a pattern. You're the person positioned to notice, address, and escalate.

AN OPENING REFLECTION

The Landing hands to a brief Coach reflection — a gut-check read of the situation — before the Phase 1 practice begins. No evaluation.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

Pacing: Present as video, or 2–3 short paragraphs. No answer options; a read/watch-and-continue screen.

Chat partner label: None yet. Ray appears in-character at Phase 2; the Coach speaks at the reflection.

Canon: All scene facts come from the Locked Scenario Canon (this slide + next). The model does not invent the signs, the grievance, or names.

Neutrality: Keep agency/unit/rank generic so Fire, Law, Dispatch, and EMS all fit.

No evaluation: Orientation only — nothing scored on the Landing.

AI PRESENTS THE SCENARIO (first-person voice · LOCKED SCENARIO CANON)

You run a shift at the agency, and Ray is one of yours — twelve years on the job, knows the work cold. A few weeks ago a lead assignment opened up, and it went to Marcus, someone newer. Ray wanted it. Since then, something's been off.

It's been small things, but they're adding up. Last week he snapped at a newer colleague on shift — sharper than the moment called for. You've heard him mutter that “management has it out for me.” And a couple of days ago he flat refused to hand a task off to Marcus, the new lead. Any one of these you might let go. All three, in two weeks, from a steady twelve-year veteran?

He hasn't done anything you could write up as a violation. But you know your people, and this isn't Ray. You're his supervisor — you're the one positioned to notice this, deal with it, and pull in help if it needs it. The question sitting in front of you is what to do now, before it becomes something bigger.

LANDING



LEARN

What changes: The learner has taken in Ray's story — the three signs, the passed-over grievance. Now the Coach steps in and asks for a gut read before any practice begins.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

Before we get into what to do — take a moment. Something about how Ray's been acting is nagging at you. What's your read on the situation right now? Anything standing out, or feeling hard to call?

Share my thoughts →

Primary action. Submitting the reflection opens the coaching conversation. No evaluation yet — the Coach reads tone, acknowledges it, and calibrates how Phase 1 is framed. A response is required to continue.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

Trigger: Fires right after the scenario Landing, before any coaching begins.

Chat partner label: Set the on-screen name to Coach. First turn with the AI Coach — not yet in the room with Ray.

Input type: Open free-text field. No answer options. The learner types or speaks freely.

On submit: Read for tone and starting assumptions (do not grade); the Coach acknowledges it and opens Phase 1.

Continue: Single primary button.

Transition — Learn → Practice (into Phase 1)

TRANSITION

LEARN



PRACTICE

What changes: The learner has shared a gut read and the Coach has calibrated. Now the learner applies the course material — reasoning through what these early signs are and what to do first. The Coach hands over the floor: this is practice, not instruction.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

Let's take a closer look at what you're actually seeing here.

Begin practicing →

No text entry on this handoff; a single tap moves the learner into Practice. Free-text resumes once the Phase 1 prompt opens.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

Trigger: Fires after the reflection feedback closes, before the Phase 1 question begins. Dynamic set-up text may bridge into this locked prompt.

Chat partner label: Keep the on-screen name as Coach — only the mode flips from Learn to Practice.

Input type: None on this handoff; a read-and-continue screen. Free-text resumes in Practice.

On tap: Switch UI to Practice and open the Phase 1 prompt. The Coach may pose ONE probing followup — Socratic only, no teaching. Max 3 learner turns.

Continue: Single primary button (Begin practicing).

AI Coach (Practice): “Three things have reached you over the last two weeks — Ray snapped at a newer colleague, muttered that management “has it out for him,” and refused to hand a task to the new lead. In your view, what is this — and what do you do first? Walk me through your thinking.”

UNTHOUGHTFUL / NEGATIVE

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Explains it away — “rough month,” “he’ll cool off.” Treats it as attitude, not a pattern. May jump straight to formal discipline, or plan to confront Ray on the floor.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Surfaces the Level 1 marker list. Reframes with the pattern: three converging signs is a pattern, not a mood. Redirects away from public confrontation and premature discipline toward assess → document → report up.

WHERE IT GOES

Coach names the miss and, at the Learn debrief, supplies whatever wasn't demonstrated.

NEUTRAL / AVERAGE

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Recognizes something's wrong and wants to address it, but reaches for one move — e.g., “I’ll pull Ray aside” — without documenting or looping in the chain. Right instinct, incomplete protocol.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Affirms addressing it. Pushes for the missing pieces: start a record, give the chain a heads-up so it's assessed together, and make the meeting private and planned.

WHERE IT GOES

One probing follow-up to draw out documentation and reporting before the Learn debrief.

STRONG / IDEAL

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Names these as Level 1 behaviors of concern. Starts a record (dates, what was observed, from whom). Reports up so it's assessed together. Plans a private meeting — and still acts despite the “is it my place?” friction.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Validates fully: that's the Level 1 protocol — observe, document, report up, meet privately. You're ahead of it instead of behind it.

WHERE IT GOES

Confirms and transitions to the Learn debrief to lock the recognition frame.

CAP / EXIT: Phase 1 is the recognition phase. Exit when the learner (a) names the signs as Level 1 behaviors of concern, (b) starts a record, (c) reports up the chain, and (d) plans a private meeting — OR at a hard cap of 3 learner turns, after which the Coach steps in and the Learn debrief supplies whatever wasn't demonstrated.

AI Coach (Practice): “In your view, what is this — and what do you do first? Walk me through your thinking.”

UNTHOUGHTFUL / NEGATIVE

LEARNER
“It’s probably nothing — Ray’s had a rough month. I’ll let it blow over.”

COACH →
“Three converging signs in two weeks is a pattern, not a mood. These are Level 1 behaviors of concern — the move is to observe, document, and flag it up, not wait.” (redirect)

NEUTRAL / AVERAGE

LEARNER
“I’ll pull Ray aside on the floor and tell him to knock it off.”

COACH →
“Addressing it is right — but public and off-the-cuff can harden a grievance. Schedule it privately, and get your chain aware first so you’re not carrying this alone.” (partial)

STRONG / IDEAL

LEARNER
“I’ll write down what I’ve seen, give my supervisor a heads-up so we assess it together, and set up a private time to talk with Ray.”

COACH →
“That’s the Level 1 protocol exactly — observe, document, report up, meet privately. You’re ahead of it instead of behind it.” (strong)

Transition — Practice → Learn (Phase 1 debrief)

TRANSITION

PRACTICE



LEARN

What changes: The learner has worked the recognition question in Practice. The Coach now steps back into Learn to deliver the substantive teaching — the Level 1 protocol — so every learner leaves with the same standard.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

Let's step back and line this up against the ladder.

Talk it through →

No text entry on this handoff; a single tap returns the learner to the Coach in Learn mode. This segment is instruction, not practice.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

Trigger: Fires once the Phase 1 practice turns resolve — after the learner's response and any single probing follow-up, or once the 3-turn cap is reached.

Chat partner label: Keep the on-screen name as Coach — only the mode flips from Practice to Learn.

Input type: None; a read-and-continue screen. This is teaching, so no free-text field opens.

On tap: Switch UI to Learn and deliver the Phase 1 Coach debrief (next slide).

Continue: Single primary button (Talk it through).

AI Coach (Learn): The Coach reflects the learner's reasoning back and delivers the Level 1 standard — every learner leaves with the same recognition frame, regardless of path.

THE RECOGNITION FRAME

NAME IT

Snapping at the crew, “management has it out for me,” refusing to work with the new lead — these are Level 1 behaviors of concern, not a rough patch.

THE PATTERN

One incident is a moment; three converging in two weeks from a steady veteran is a signal worth acting on.

THE LEVEL 1 PROTOCOL

OBSERVE + DOCUMENT

Start a record — dates, what was observed, from whom. It anchors the incident log and any follow-through.

REPORT UP

Loop in your chain so it's assessed together. Don't quietly absorb it — that's an information silo.

MEET PRIVATELY

Plan a private conversation with Ray — never a floor confrontation.

TWO PRINCIPLES

DON'T SIT ON IT

The incidents that go wrong are almost always the ones somebody kept to themselves.

DON'T GO IT ALONE

Recognition and response are a chain-of-command job, not a solo one — this carries through every level ahead.



What changes: With the Level 1 protocol established, the Coach hands the floor back — now the learner runs the private conversation with Ray live. What they type is what they say to him.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

Now let's put you in the room with Ray. Step in whenever you're ready.

Step into the room →

Launches the in-character scene. No text entry here; a single tap continues into the meeting with Ray.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

Trigger: Fires right after the Phase 1 Coach debrief closes in Learn, at the action pivot into the meeting.

Chat partner label: Switch the on-screen name from Coach to Ray. The learner now acts in the scene, not with the Coach.

Input type: Open free-text field. No answer options. Placeholder: “Respond to Ray...”.

On submit: Route the text into the Phase 2 in-character logic; Ray reacts by how he's met — respect + limits, or dismissal.

Continue: Single primary button (Step into the room).

Ray (locked open): “You’ve got a private room and twenty minutes. Ray drops into the chair across from you, arms crossed: “So what is this — a write-up? Because I’m the problem now? Marcus gets my job and I’m the one in here.””

UNTHOUGHTFUL / NEGATIVE

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Dismisses the grievance, threatens discipline, or dresses Ray down. Leaves with no clear limits and no record. Meets defensiveness with more heat.

IN-CHARACTER LOGIC (Ray)

Ray hardens and shuts down — “So I’m the bad guy. Noted.” The grievance curdles, foreshadowing Level 2.

SCENE PROGRESSION

Coach flags the extreme (shaming with no path) and offers a replay before the debrief.

NEUTRAL / AVERAGE

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Hears Ray out with empathy but stops there — “let’s keep things civil” — without setting specific limits, naming steps, or documenting.

IN-CHARACTER LOGIC (Ray)

Ray settles slightly (“...Fine.”) but nothing concrete changes; he’s heard but not held to anything.

SCENE PROGRESSION

Coach pushes one turn for the specific behavioral expectations, support, and a record.

STRONG / IDEAL

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Keeps it private and calm; hears the grievance without validating any threat; sets clear limits and names corrective steps; gives Ray a stake; points to EAP; documents and keeps the chain informed.

IN-CHARACTER LOGIC (Ray)

Met with respect + firm limits, Ray engages and de-escalates — “I didn’t realize it was showing that much. I can work with that.”

SCENE PROGRESSION

Reaches a real plan; Ray leaves with limits, steps, and support. Ready to transition to Learn.

CAP / EXIT: Phase 2 is the in-character role-play. Exit when the learner (a) hears the grievance without validating any threat, (b) sets clear limits + names corrective steps, (c) points to support (EAP), and (d) commits to document + keep the chain informed — OR at a hard cap of 6 learner turns, after which the Coach steps in and the debrief supplies what’s missing.

Ray (locked open): ““So what is this — a write-up? Because I’m the problem now? Marcus gets my job and I’m the one in here.””

UNTHOUGHTFUL / NEGATIVE

LEARNER
“This isn’t about Marcus. Your attitude is the problem and it stops now, or we go to formal discipline.”

RAY →
“Unbelievable. So I’m the bad guy. Noted.” (shuts down; grievance hardens)

COACH
Name the behavior and set limits — but don’t corner him. Leave a path.

NEUTRAL / AVERAGE

LEARNER
“I hear you’re frustrated about the promotion. That’s fair. Let’s just try to keep things civil, okay?”

RAY →
“...Fine.” (heard, but no real limits or steps)

COACH
Good empathy — now set the specific behavioral expectations, point to support, and document them.

STRONG / IDEAL

LEARNER
“I get that getting passed over stung, and I want to hear that. But I’ve seen how it’s landing on the crew, and that has to change. Here’s what I need to see — and do you know we’ve got EAP if you want it?”

RAY →
“...I didn’t realize it was showing that much. Okay. I can work with that.” (engages; de-escalates)



What changes: The meeting with Ray has played out. The Coach steps back in to work through how it landed — grounded in the Level 1 conversation standard — before the situation escalates.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

Let's unpack how that landed.

Talk it through →

No text entry; a single tap returns the learner to the Coach in Learn mode.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

Trigger: Fires once the Phase 2 scene resolves — after Ray reacts, or once the 6-turn cap is reached. All paths converge here.

Chat partner label: Switch the on-screen name from Ray back to Coach.

Input type: None at this handoff; a read-and-continue screen.

On tap: Open the Phase 2 Coach debrief: the respect-plus-limits standard and what documentation the meeting requires.

Continue: Single primary button (Talk it through).

Phase 2 — Coach Debrief (Learn)

MODE: LEARN

VERSION A — ANNOTATED

AI Coach (Learn): The Coach names what a strong Level 1 conversation holds together — respect and firm limits at once — and closes any gap in limits, support, or documentation.

HOLD BOTH AT ONCE

HEAR THE GRIEVANCE

Let the frustration be real and give Ray a stake — ask what he thinks would help. Being passed over stung; that can be true without excusing the behavior.

SET FIRM LIMITS

Name the specific behavior that has to change and the corrective steps you expect to see. Empathy without limits leaves nothing to hold.

RESPECT, NOT PUNISHMENT

PRIVATE + DIGNIFIED

Keep it private and calm; treat Ray with dignity. Public or punitive handling hardens the grievance — the opposite of what you want.

POINT TO SUPPORT

Offer EAP as a real resource, not a threat. The goal is a path forward, not just a warning.

PUT IT ON THE RECORD

DOCUMENT THE MEETING

Note what was discussed and agreed — it feeds the incident log and protects everyone if things progress.

KEEP THE CHAIN INFORMED

Your chain stays aware of the conversation and the plan. You are still not carrying this alone.

Transition — Learn → Practice (into Phase 3)

TRANSITION

LEARN



PRACTICE

What changes: A week passes. The Coach hands the floor back — but the situation has moved. What surfaces next is no longer a coaching problem, and the learner has to recognize that in the moment.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

A week goes by, and something new lands on your desk. Back to you.

Keep going →

No text entry on this handoff; a single tap moves the learner into Practice. Free-text resumes once the Phase 3 prompt opens.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

Trigger: Fires right after the Phase 2 debrief closes in Learn, before the escalation lands.

Chat partner label: Keep the on-screen name as Coach; the Phase 3 stimulus is delivered as a scene/report, with the Coach available.

Input type: None on this handoff; free-text resumes once the Phase 3 prompt opens.

On tap: Switch UI to Practice and present the forwarded group-chat message. The Coach may pose ONE probing follow-up. Max 3 learner turns.

Continue: Single primary button (Keep going).

Phase 3 — It Escalates · Level 2

MODE: PRACTICE → LEARN

VERSION A — ANNOTATED

Scene (locked): “A colleague forwards you a message Ray posted in the crew group chat: “Marcus better watch himself. This place is going to regret what they did to me.” Ray has also called out of his last two shifts. What do you do — specifically?”

UNTHOUGHTFUL / NEGATIVE

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Keeps treating it as a performance issue — “I’ll call Ray and give him a chance to explain.” Tries to resolve a credible threat one-on-one. Doesn’t recognize the level changed.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Flags that this is a credible threat toward a specific person — not a coaching moment. Redirects: secure Marcus, notify the chain, involve security/911 per the plan; don’t confront Ray solo.

WHERE IT GOES

Scene holds the threat and Marcus’s safety in play until both are addressed.

NEUTRAL / AVERAGE

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Reports it and preserves the message — right instinct — but stops at logging it, without closing the loop on protecting Marcus and the crew right now.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Affirms reporting and preserving. Pushes the safety step: make sure Marcus and the crew are protected in the moment, not just that it’s documented.

WHERE IT GOES

One probing follow-up to convert “logged” into “secured,” then the debrief.

STRONG / IDEAL

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Names it as Level 2 — a credible threat and “me against them.” Secures the people at risk, notifies the chain immediately, involves 911/security if imminent, preserves the message, and does not confront Ray alone.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Confirms the Level 2 response: safety first, escalate through the chain, document, don’t go it alone.

WHERE IT GOES

Transitions to the Learn debrief to lock the escalation standard.

CAP / EXIT: Phase 3 is the recognize-the-shift phase. Exit when the learner (a) recognizes this as a Level 2 credible threat, (b) secures the people at risk, (c) notifies the chain / involves 911, and (d) preserves the message without confronting Ray alone — OR at a hard cap of 3 learner turns, after which the Coach steps in and the debrief supplies what’s missing.

Scene (locked): “A message Ray posted is forwarded to you: “Marcus better watch himself. This place is going to regret what they did to me.” He’s also called out of his last two shifts. What do you do — specifically?”

UNTHOUGHTFUL / NEGATIVE

LEARNER
“I’ll call Ray directly and give him a chance to explain before I make this a whole thing.”

SCENE / COACH →
“That’s a credible threat toward a specific person. This isn’t yours to resolve one-on-one — secure Marcus, notify your chain, and involve security/911 per the plan.” (redirect)

NEUTRAL / AVERAGE

LEARNER
“I’ll report it to my supervisor and keep the message.”

SCENE / COACH →
“Right instinct on reporting and preserving it — now close the loop on safety: make sure Marcus and the crew are protected right now, not just that it’s logged.” (partial)

STRONG / IDEAL

LEARNER
“I’m treating this as a threat. I’ll make sure Marcus is safe and looped in, notify my chain and security immediately, preserve the message, and follow our violence-prevention plan — I’m not confronting Ray on my own.”

SCENE / COACH →
“That’s the Level 2 response: safety first, escalate through the chain, document, don’t go it alone.” (strong)



What changes: The threat has surfaced and the learner has acted (or hasn't). The Coach steps back in to name what changed — Level 1 to Level 2 — and lock the escalation response before the emergency.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

Let's name what just changed.

Talk it through →

No text entry; a single tap returns the learner to the Coach in Learn mode. All paths converge here.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

- Trigger:** Fires once the Phase 3 turns resolve — after the learner's response and any probing follow-up, or once the 3-turn cap is reached.
- Chat partner label:** Keep the on-screen name as Coach.
- Input type:** None; a read-and-continue screen.
- On tap:** Open the Phase 3 Coach debrief: recognizing the level change and the secure/notify/escalate standard.
- Continue:** Single primary button (Talk it through).

Phase 3 — Coach Debrief (Learn)

MODE: LEARN

VERSION A — ANNOTATED

AI Coach (Learn): The Coach names the level change and delivers the Level 2 standard — the response has to change the moment a credible threat appears.

THE LEVEL HAS CHANGED

READ THE MARKERS

“Me against them,” a named target, a threat that others will regret it — these are Level 2 escalation markers, not venting.

STOP COACHING

A credible threat is not a performance conversation. The moment it appears, the goal shifts from correcting behavior to protecting people.

THE LEVEL 2 RESPONSE

SECURE SAFETY FIRST

Make sure Marcus and anyone else at risk are protected right now — not just that the threat is on record.

NOTIFY + ESCALATE

Notify the chain immediately, follow the agency's WVPP, and involve 911/security if the threat is imminent.

PRESERVE + DON'T GO ALONE

Save the message and document; never try to talk Ray down solo.

WHY IT MATTERS

SPEED OVER CERTAINTY

You don't have to be sure it's real to act — securing safety and notifying is the correct move even if it de-escalates.

STAY CALM + FACTUAL

Avoid escalating language. Your job is to route this to the right people, fast.



What changes: It's not over. The Coach hands off one last time — into a Level 3 emergency. This is a decision point, not a confrontation, and it moves fast.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

It's not over. One more moment — step in when you're ready.

Step into the moment →

Launches the emergency decision scene. No role-play with Ray — rapid decisions only. No text entry here; a single tap continues.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

- Trigger:** Fires right after the Phase 3 debrief closes in Learn, at the pivot into the emergency.
- Chat partner label:** Switch the on-screen name to Narrator. There is no in-character confrontation with Ray at Level 3.
- Input type:** Open free-text field. No answer options. Placeholder: “What do you do, right now?”.
- On submit:** Route into the Phase 4 decision logic. Keep it a decision point — protect people and defer to law enforcement, not confront.
- Continue:** Single primary button (Step into the moment).

Narrator (locked): “Word reaches you on shift: Ray is in the parking lot, and someone says he may be armed. This is a decision point, not a conversation. What do you do — right now?”

UNTHOUGHTFUL / NEGATIVE

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Tries to intervene personally — goes to the parking lot to “talk Ray down,” or delays calling for help to confirm the report first. Treats it as something to handle, not an emergency to escalate.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Names this as a Level 3 emergency. Redirects hard: call 911 first, secure your own safety, do not approach. Heroics endanger the learner and everyone else.

WHERE IT GOES

Scene holds until the learner calls it in and moves people to safety.

NEUTRAL / AVERAGE

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Calls 911 — right first move — but stops short: forgets to account for and move others, or doesn't prepare to give a description and exact location to responders.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Affirms calling it in. Adds the missing steps: protect yourself, account for and move others to safety, and cooperate with responders.

WHERE IT GOES

One probing follow-up to complete the emergency response, then debrief.

STRONG / IDEAL

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Calls 911 and agency emergency contacts, secures own safety, accounts for and moves others, cooperates with law enforcement (ready to give a description and exact location). Afterward: records it and follows the WVPP.

COACH RESPONSE LOGIC

Confirms the Level 3 response: call it in, protect people, and let law enforcement run it — respond correctly, don't be the hero.

WHERE IT GOES

Transitions to the closing debrief and feedback.

CAP / EXIT: Phase 4 is the emergency decision point. Exit when the learner (a) calls 911 / emergency contacts, (b) secures personal safety, (c) accounts for and moves others, and (d) defers to law enforcement — OR at a hard cap of 3 learner turns, after which the Coach steps in and the debrief supplies what's missing.

Narrator (locked): *“Ray is in the parking lot and may be armed. This is a decision point, not a confrontation.”*

RAPID DECISIONS — no role-play with Ray

- Call 911 and the agency's emergency contacts. (Slide 28)
- Secure your own safety first; leave the area if it's at risk.
- Account for and move others to safety.
- Cooperate with law enforcement; be ready to give a description and exact location.
- Afterward: record it in the violent-incident log and follow the WVPP. (Slides 22, 24)

HOW THE DECISIONS READ

NEGATIVE

“I'll go out and try to talk him down.” → Narrator: This is a Level 3 emergency — call 911, protect yourself, do not approach.

AVERAGE

“I'll call 911.” → Narrator: The right first move — now account for the crew and be ready to give responders a location and description.

STRONG

“Call it in, get myself and the crew to safety, account for everyone, and let law enforcement run it— I'll have a description and exact location ready.” → Narrator: That's the Level 3 response.



What changes: The emergency has passed. The Coach steps back in to walk the decisions through and lock the Level 3 standard before the closing recap.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

Let's walk back through those decisions.

Talk it through →

No text entry; a single tap returns the learner to the Coach in Learn mode. All paths converge here.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

- Trigger:** Fires once the Phase 4 decision turns resolve, or once the 3-turn cap is reached.
- Chat partner label:** Switch the on-screen name from Narrator back to Coach.
- Input type:** None; a read-and-continue screen.
- On tap:** Open the Phase 4 Coach debrief: the emergency-response standard and the documentation that follows.
- Continue:** Single primary button (Talk it through).

Phase 4 — Coach Debrief (Learn)

MODE: LEARN

VERSION A — ANNOTATED

AI Coach (Learn): The Coach delivers the Level 3 emergency standard — respond correctly, don't be the hero — and names the documentation that closes the loop.

IT'S AN EMERGENCY

A DECISION, NOT A DUEL

A weapon or direct threat is Level 3. Your role is to make fast, correct decisions — not to confront Ray or resolve it yourself.

911 FIRST

Call 911 and the agency's emergency contacts immediately. Don't wait to confirm — err toward calling it in.

PROTECT PEOPLE

YOURSELF FIRST

Secure your own safety; leave the area if it's at risk. You can't help anyone if you're in harm's way.

THEN OTHERS

Account for and move the crew to safety.

COOPERATE

Let law enforcement run it; be ready with a description and exact location.

CLOSE THE LOOP

DOCUMENT IT

Afterward, record the incident in the violent-incident log and follow the agency's WVPP.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Every level came back to the same two principles: don't sit on information, and don't go it alone.



What changes: The ladder has played out end to end. Now the experience closes — the personalized recap and the SME-validated ideal response appear as the closing Landing modal.

WHAT THE LEARNER SEES

LOCKED ON-SCREEN PROMPT

That's the full ladder. Let's look back at how you handled it — and what the experts say works best.

See my feedback →

No text entry — a single tap continues to feedback. Every learner reaches the closing feedback regardless of path.

DESIGN NOTES FOR ENGINEERING

Trigger: Fires after the Phase 4 debrief. All paths converge to the same handoff to the feedback modal.

Chat partner label: The Coach hands off to the closing Landing modal (personalized recap + locked ideal response).

Input type: None. A read-and-continue screen.

On tap: Generate and show the closing personalized feedback plus the SME-validated ideal response (the full ladder).

Continue: Single primary button (See my feedback).

FINAL FEEDBACK STRUCTURE (AI generates for every learner)

Personalized Recap

Reflects back 2–3 specific things the learner said across the phases, using their language. Signals the conversation was real and their choices mattered.

Strengths

Affirms what they recognized and did well — early catching, respect-plus-limits, recognizing the level change, protecting people.

Things to Hold Onto

Names any gaps — documentation, looping in the chain, securing safety — as growth, not correction.

Compliance Anchor

The full SME/LED-validated ladder appears for every learner regardless of path. This is the audit-defensible close.

IDEAL RESPONSE — SME / LED VALIDATED (slides 26–28)

LEVEL 1 — Early warning signs

Behaviors of concern. Observe, document, report up, meet privately and set limits with respect.

LEVEL 2 — A credible threat

Secure safety, notify the chain, involve 911; stop coaching.

LEVEL 3 — A weapon / direct threat

911, personal safety first, protect others, cooperate with law enforcement.

THROUGHOUT

Document for the incident log and follow your agency's WVPP.

TWO PRINCIPLES

Don't sit on information, and don't go it alone.

AI COACH — EXAMPLE CLOSE (strong-path learner)

“Look at how early you caught this. When Ray was just short and bitter, you didn't wait for it to get worse — you named those as behaviors of concern, put them on the record, and brought your chain in instead of carrying it quietly. In the room, you did the hard both-and: you let the grievance be real and you set clear limits, with a path and support, not just a warning.

And when that message landed, you recognized the ground had shifted — you stopped coaching, made Marcus's safety the priority, and escalated the right way instead of trying to fix it yourself. If it reached the parking lot, your job was exactly what you did: call it in, protect people, and let law enforcement run it.

One thing to carry forward: that instinct to loop others in early is the whole game — the incidents that go wrong are almost always the ones somebody sat on.”

ONE SCENARIO, THE FULL LADDER

Recognize the level	Phases 1, 3, 4
Level 1 response	Phases 1–2
Level 2 response	Phase 3
Level 3 response · decision	Phase 4
Report up · document · WVPP	Throughout

Differs from the others: the evolution is contingent on the learner, not scripted.

LOCKED SUMMARY FEEDBACK (delivered to every learner)

“Recognizing and responding to workplace violence is about matching your response to the level. Early warning signs — intimidation, a hardening grievance, refusing to cooperate — are Level 1 behaviors of concern: observe them, document them, report up your chain, and meet privately to set limits with respect. A credible threat is Level 2: secure the people at risk, notify the chain, involve 911 if warranted, and stop trying to coach. A weapon or direct threat is Level 3, an emergency: call 911, protect yourself and others first, and cooperate with law enforcement. Two principles run through all of it — don't sit on information, and don't try to handle it alone. Document throughout and follow your agency's Workplace Violence Prevention Plan.”

SOURCE REFERENCES (PS-801)

Slide 26 — Level 1

Early warning signs / behaviors of concern; observe, document, report, meet privately.

Slide 27 — Level 2

Escalation markers; secure safety, notify, 911 if warranted.

Slide 28 — Level 3

Emergency response; 911, personal safety, protect others, cooperate with law enforcement.

Slides 22, 24 — WVPP

Violent-incident log and the agency's Workplace Violence Prevention Plan.

Slide 8 — Reporting

Report up the chain; avoid information silos.

Phase Map — Turn & Mode Structure

REFERENCE

Phase / Beat	Max Turns	Chat Role	Chat Description or “Locked Text”	Params	UI Mode
Scene Setup (Landing)	N/A	Narrator	(opening scene — Ray’s supervisor; the three signs; the grievance). Locked canon, slides 9–10	Locked	Landing
Reflection Prompt	N/A	Coach	“Before we get into what to do — take a moment... what’s your read on the situation right now?”	Locked	Learn
Reflection Response	2	Learner	Learner input — gut read, not scored	Dynamic	Learn
Transition → Practice	N/A	Coach	“Let’s take a closer look at what you’re actually seeing here.” [Begin practicing]	Locked	Learn → Practice
P1 · Notice & Assess	3	Learner ⇄ Coach	“What is this — and what do you do first?” Recognize Level 1, document, report up, plan private meeting	Dynamic	Practice
Transition → Learn	N/A	Coach	“Let’s step back and line this up against the ladder.” [Talk it through]	Locked	Practice → Learn
P1 · Coach Debrief	N/A	Coach	Delivers the Level 1 protocol: observe · document · report up · meet privately	Dynamic	Learn
Transition → Practice	N/A	Coach → Ray	“Now let’s put you in the room with Ray.” [Step into the room]	Locked	Learn → Practice
P2 · The Conversation	6	Learner ⇄ Ray	In-character role-play. Ray opens locked; reacts by how he’s met (respect + limits, or dismissal)	Dynamic	Practice
Transition → Learn	N/A	Coach	“Let’s unpack how that landed.” [Talk it through]	Locked	Practice → Learn
P2 · Coach Debrief	N/A	Coach	Respect + firm limits; name steps; point to EAP; document; keep chain informed	Dynamic	Learn
Transition → Practice	N/A	Coach	“A week goes by... Back to you.” [Keep going]	Locked	Learn → Practice
P3 · It Escalates	3	Learner ⇄ Scene	Forwarded threat message (locked). Recognize Level 2; secure safety; notify; preserve; don’t go alone	Dynamic	Practice
Transition → Learn	N/A	Coach	“Let’s name what just changed.” [Talk it through]	Locked	Practice → Learn
P3 · Coach Debrief	N/A	Coach	Level change; secure · notify/escalate · preserve; stop coaching	Dynamic	Learn
Transition → Practice	N/A	Coach → Narrator	“One more moment — step in when you’re ready.” [Step into the moment]	Locked	Learn → Practice
P4 · Emergency	3	Learner ⇄ Narrator	Parking-lot report (locked). Decision point: 911; personal safety; protect others; cooperate	Dynamic	Practice
Transition → Learn	N/A	Coach	“Let’s walk back through those decisions.” [Talk it through]	Locked	Practice → Learn
P4 · Coach Debrief	N/A	Coach	Level 3 response; document incident log + WVPP; the two principles	Dynamic	Learn
Transition → Landing	N/A	Coach	“Let’s look back at how you handled it...” [See my feedback]	Dynamic	Learn → Landing
Closing Summary	N/A	Coach	Recap · Strengths · Growth · Ideal ladder · Locked summary (slide 35)	Dyn./Locked	Landing

Locked text is verbatim on-screen copy; Dynamic beats are AI-generated within the locked canon. Practice = in-character/decision; Learn = Coach debrief that guarantees the correct approach lands.